

# Adjustment Refusal: Alliance Pest Control

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Your family has owned Alliance Pest Control in San Diego since the 1940s. Alliance serves the entire county with pest control solutions, from Pacific Beach to Julian. Although a student at SDSU, you often help out with administrative and customer-service tasks, as did family members of your parents’ and grandparents’ generation.

Earlier this month, longtime client Barbara Kempe called to report a termite infestation in her 1940s garden-court bungalow in South Park, San Diego. Ms. Kempe will need to replace the entire hardwood floor of her home. She claims that Alliance is responsible for the cost of her repairs.

After researching the case, you learn that Ms. Kempe owns the entire garden-court complex. She lives in the largest bungalow at the back and rents out the remaining units. You also discover that all of the units are protected under some form of termite coverage with Alliance, but that coverage varies by unit.

The largest unit, hers, is protected by the "Alliance Premier" protection plan which covers annual treatments and the full costs of repairs should an infestation occur. However the remaining units, including the one with the current infestation, are covered by the "Alliance Standard" protection plan. "Alliance Standard" covers only annual prevention treatments; designed for newer homes constructed with treated wood, it does not cover the cost of repairs should an infestation occur. However, that plan will cover retreatment once the repairs have been made.

You need to write to Ms. Kempe and inform her that Alliance Pest Control is not responsible for the cost of her floor repairs in the rented unit. Barbara has been a client for over 30 years. Maintain her goodwill while making sure she fully understands why the claim is being rejected.

## Guidelines

- As you draft the letter, make sure you
- review the Bad-News Assignment Description
  - use the appropriate approach (direct or indirect)
  - set up your reasoning effectively
  - present the justification (make your case) objectively
  - refuse Ms. Kempe’s request positively in order to maintain goodwill

## Resources

Review specific negative message types throughout Rentz chapter 6, but focus on Learning Outcome 6-5 (pp. 146-48), including all sample messages presented and discussed under that outcome.

## Contact Information

Use these addresses in your letter:

|                       |                     |
|-----------------------|---------------------|
| [Your Name]           | Barbara Kempe       |
| Alliance Pest Control | 4156 Fern Street    |
| 12125 El Norte Road   | San Diego, CA 92104 |
| Building 12           |                     |
| Santee, CA 92119      |                     |